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Where Minds Pollinate

Class 10
English
Poem BLUE
NOTES

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UNIT 8

BLUE (Poem)

Text Type: Poem

Theme: Literature & Poetry

Subthemes: Human Relationships

Stanza 1:

**She was born pink and soft with all of her toes
She had my eyes and her mother's nose
She cried for a moment and then settled down
The angel of my life with hair of brown**

Paraphrasing:

The baby was born healthy and soft, her skin pink and delicate, with all her tiny toes perfectly formed. She looked like a perfect blend of both parents, having his eyes and her mother's nose. At first, she cried briefly, but soon she calmed and became peaceful. She quickly became the most precious and cherished part of his life. With her soft brown hair, she seemed like a little angel brought into their world. Her arrival filled their hearts with joy and hope. She was truly a blessing to us all. He felt an immediate and deep bond with his little daughter. Her innocent face filled his heart with immense love and happiness. From the very beginning, he knew that she would always be the most precious part of his life.

Stanza 2:

**Months went by and we watched her grow
Something was wrong and we had to know
The doctor called with concern on his mind
And told me my angel had been born blind**

Paraphrasing:

Months passed as they lovingly watched her grow, but they began to sense that something was not quite right. Worried and unsure, they sought answers to understand what was happening. Finally, the doctor called them with serious concern. With a heavy heart, he informed them that their precious angel had been born blind. The news was difficult to accept, and it left both stunned and anxious about what the future might hold for her. Despite the shock, they knew they had to face this challenge together, determined to support her in every way possible. Although the truth was painful, their love for their daughter remained unchanged. They realized that she would need even greater care, support, and encouragement from them. They decided to remain strong and help her overcome every difficulty in life.

Stanza 3:

**I cried for a while and then I got mad
This was not my idea of being a dad
So from that day forward I started a plight
To be her eyes in life and her heart of sight**

Paraphrasing:

At first, he cried and felt overwhelmed with sadness, but soon anger took its place. This wasn't how he imagined fatherhood to be. From that moment on, he made it his mission to guide her through life, to be her eyes when she couldn't see, and to give her a vision through his heart and love. He vowed to

support her fully, helping her experience the world in every way he could. Instead of allowing sadness to defeat him, he turned it into courage and determination. He decided to become his daughter's guide and strength throughout her life. His love for her gave him the courage to face every challenge that lay ahead.

Stanza 4 :

**As the years passed by she started to grow
Into a beautiful child with a need to know
Each day was spent teaching all that I knew
Until one day when she asked about blue**

Paraphrasing:

As time went on, she grew older and blossomed into a beautiful child full of curiosity and a strong desire to learn about the world around her. Every day, he dedicated himself to teaching her everything he had learned, sharing knowledge and experiences to help her understand life better. She absorbed the lessons eagerly, always asking questions and seeking answers. One special day, she asked him about the color blue, a question that showed how deeply she wanted to connect with the world that she could not see. This moment marked a new chapter in her learning, as she began to explore ideas that went beyond what he could easily explain. He tried to introduce her to the world through words, sounds, feelings, and experiences. Her eagerness to learn always encouraged him to teach her more. However, her question about blue presented a challenge that was very difficult for him to answer.

Stanza 5:

**I tried to define it but my efforts were in vain
Only sighted descriptions were the way to explain
She had no way of knowing what I was trying to say
And for the very first time I failed her that day**

Paraphrasing:

He made an effort to explain what the color blue meant, but his attempts were unsuccessful. The only descriptions he could think of were based on how sighted people perceive colors, which she could not understand. She couldn't grasp what he was trying to convey because her experience of the world was different from mine. For the first time, he realized that his usual way of explaining things wasn't enough. He felt a deep sense of failure because he couldn't help her understand something so simple yet so complex to describe without sight. It was a difficult moment for both of them, as he struggled to find the right words and she struggled to imagine something she had never seen. He realized that certain experiences cannot easily be described through words alone. He wished that somehow he could make her experience colors as a sighted person could. Although he felt helpless, he remained determined to help her understand the world in every possible way.

Stanza 6:

**Life went on and as she grew
She formed her thoughts on what is blue
Wanting to know just what others could see
Inside her mind it became reality**

Paraphrasing:

Life continued, and as she grew older, she began to develop her own ideas about what the color blue might be. Although she had never seen it with her eyes, she was curious and eager to understand what others experienced when they saw that color. She wondered what it truly meant and longed to grasp its significance. Over time, through her imagination and the descriptions she heard, she created her own version of blue inside her mind. This imagined color became real to her in a unique way, shaped by her feelings and thoughts rather than sight. Even without seeing, she found a way to connect with the world around her by giving meaning to what others took for granted. Her understanding grew deeper as she made this invisible color a part of her reality. Her blindness could not stop her imagination or her desire to understand new things. She gradually discovered that the world could also be understood through emotions and feelings. In this way, blue became something meaningful to her even though she had never physically seen it.

Stanza 7:

**On her sixteenth birthday our lives got better
We received good news in a doctor's letter
He said he could help and that this just might
Give the eyes of my angel the gift of sight**

Paraphrasing:

On her sixteenth birthday, a hopeful change came into our lives. They received encouraging news in a letter from the doctor. The letter brought the promise that there was a chance to improve her condition. The doctor explained that he had a way to help her see, offering the possibility of giving his angel the precious gift of sight. This news filled them with hope and excitement for the future. After years of uncertainty and struggle, they finally had something to look forward to. The thought of her being able to see the world around her was both thrilling and emotional. It marked a turning point in their journey, inspiring them to believe in the possibility of miracles. The possibility of gaining sight seemed like a dream coming true for both of them. He eagerly hoped that the treatment would succeed and allow his daughter to see the beautiful world around her. After so many difficult years, their hearts were finally filled with fresh hope and happiness.

Stanza 8:

**I will never forget what she asked to see
When she opened her eyes and first saw me
She looked at me with her eyes of new
And asked me to show her the color of blue I said,**

Paraphrasing:

He will always remember the moment she opened her eyes for the very first time and looked at him. It was a special and unforgettable moment. She gazed at him with her new eyes, full of wonder and curiosity. The first thing she wanted to know was what the color blue looked like. She asked him to show her this color, eager to understand what she had never been able to see before. Her question was simple but deeply meaningful, as it represented her desire to connect with the world through her sight. That moment was filled with emotion, hope, and a sense of new beginnings. It was a powerful reminder of how much she wanted to experience the beauty of the world. He felt a strong urge to help her understand and appreciate the colors she had long only imagined.

Stanza 9 :

**Look at my eyes, for they are blue
The day you were born they watched over you
All through the years they never looked away
They will always be with you and will never stray**

Paraphrasing:

He told her to look into his eyes because they are blue. Since the day she was born, his eyes had been watching over her, protecting and caring for her. Throughout all these years, his eyes had never left her side, always keeping her safe. No matter what happens, his gaze will always be with her, loyal and constant, never wandering away. They will be a reminder of his love and presence, guiding her through life. By showing her blue eyes, he connected the color blue with his lifelong love for her. His eyes symbolized the care, protection, and guidance he had always given her. In this way, blue became much more than a color; it became a symbol of a father's unconditional love.

Stanza 10:

**She smiled at me and said that she always knew
About what the meaning was of the color blue
Throughout her life she could always see
With the eyes of her heart instilled from me**

Paraphrasing:

She smiled warmly and told him that she had always understood the true meaning of the color blue. Even without sight, she had known what blue represented deep inside her heart. Throughout her life, she had been able to "see" in a different way—through the feelings and love that he had taught her. It was not just a color to her, but a symbol of something much deeper. The understanding and vision she possessed came from the love and care he gave her, guiding her heart and mind. This special insight helped her experience the world beyond physical sight. Her words made him realize that true vision does not always depend upon the eyes. She had experienced blue through the love, protection, and affection surrounding her throughout childhood. Her heart had understood something that her eyes had never been able to see.

Stanza 11:

**To her the color had a meaning more than just sight
Blue had a feeling that gave her an insight
Throughout the years as both our hearts grew
She told me that Love was the color Blue**

Paraphrasing:

For the girl, the color blue had a meaning far beyond what could simply be seen with the eyes. Blue was connected with a deep feeling that had given her an understanding of life even during the years when she could not see. As she and her father grew together through the years, their emotional bond became stronger. She finally explained to her father that, in her mind and heart, blue had always represented love. The love and care of her father had given a special meaning to the color throughout her life. She understood that some of the most beautiful things in life are felt by the heart rather than seen by the eyes. Therefore, for her, blue became the perfect symbol of her father's everlasting love.

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i. **Answer the question**

1. Comment on the initial challenge the narrator faced after the birth of the child.

The narrator's initial challenge was discovering that his daughter had been born blind. At first, he was very happy because she was a beautiful and healthy baby. However, after a few months, the doctor told him that she could not see. This news made the father very sad and angry because he had imagined a different life for his daughter. He felt helpless because he knew that she would face difficulties in understanding and experiencing the world through sight.

ii. **How did the narrator attempt to overcome the challenges posed by the child being blind?**

The narrator decided to become his daughter's "eyes in life." Instead of allowing her blindness to make him hopeless, he took responsibility for teaching and guiding her. He spent time explaining things to her and answering her questions. He tried to describe the things she could not see and helped her understand the world through words and experiences. His love, patience, and continuous support helped the child develop confidence and knowledge despite her blindness.

iii. **Discuss how the event marked a positive turning point in the narrator's and the child's lives.**

A major positive turning point came on the girl's sixteenth birthday, when the doctor gave the family the hopeful news that her eyesight might be restored. The possibility of gaining sight changed their lives completely. The daughter finally received the gift of sight and was able to see the world and her father for the first time.

For the father, this was also a deeply emotional moment because his long struggle to help his daughter had finally led to something wonderful. When she opened her eyes, she looked at her father and saw his blue eyes. This moment strengthened their emotional bond and brought great happiness to both of them.

iv. **How did the narrator use the color blue to symbolize something meaningful to the child?**

The narrator used blue as a symbol of love, care, protection, and emotional connection.

At first, blue was simply a color that the blind girl wanted to understand. Her father tried to explain it to her, but she could not understand a color that she had never seen. Later, when she gained her eyesight, the first blue thing she saw was her father's blue eyes.

Therefore, blue became connected with her father and his unconditional love for her. At the end of the poem, she says that love was the color blue. Thus, blue represents much more than a physical color—it represents the deep love between the father and daughter.

v. **In what way did the child's perception of the color blue change over time?**

Initially, the girl wanted to know what blue looked like because she was curious about the world that she could not see. Her father tried to explain it, but his descriptions were not enough for her.

As she grew older, she began to create her own understanding of blue in her imagination. Even without physical sight, she developed a mental picture and emotional feeling connected with the color.

After she gained her eyesight, she finally saw blue with her own eyes. However, she realized that blue had already had a deeper meaning for her. She associated it with her father's love. Therefore, her understanding changed from a simple visual color to a symbol of love and affection.

vi. **Elaborate the rhyme scheme of the given poem.**

The poem mainly follows an ABB rhyme scheme. This means that the first two lines rhyme with each other, and the third and fourth lines also rhyme with each other.

For example:

Toes — nose → A A

Brown — down → B B So

the pattern is:

A A B B

Another example is:

Mad — dad → A A

Plight — sight → B B

The regular rhyme scheme gives the poem a musical and memorable quality. It also makes the narrative flow smoothly and helps emphasize important ideas and emotions.

vii. **Locate phrases in the poem.**

Some important phrases from the poem are:

1. **“the angel of my life”** — refers to the narrator’s beloved daughter and shows his deep love for her.
2. **“born blind”** — tells us that the child was unable to see from birth.
3. **“a plight”** — refers to a difficult or painful situation.
4. **“her eyes in life”** — means that the father decided to guide and help his blind daughter as if he were her eyes.
5. **“a need to know”** — shows the child’s strong curiosity and desire to learn.
6. **“efforts were in vain”** — means that the father’s attempts to explain blue were unsuccessful.
7. **“the gift of sight”** — refers to the ability to see, which the girl received after the treatment.
8. **“eyes of my angel”** — refers to the daughter’s eyes and also expresses the father’s affection for her.
9. **“eyes of her heart”** — means that she understood things through her feelings and emotions rather than physical sight.
10. **“Love was the color Blue”** — means that, for the girl, blue became a symbol of her father’s love.